Track 9B

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Track 9B — Falsification Search: Robustness Verification

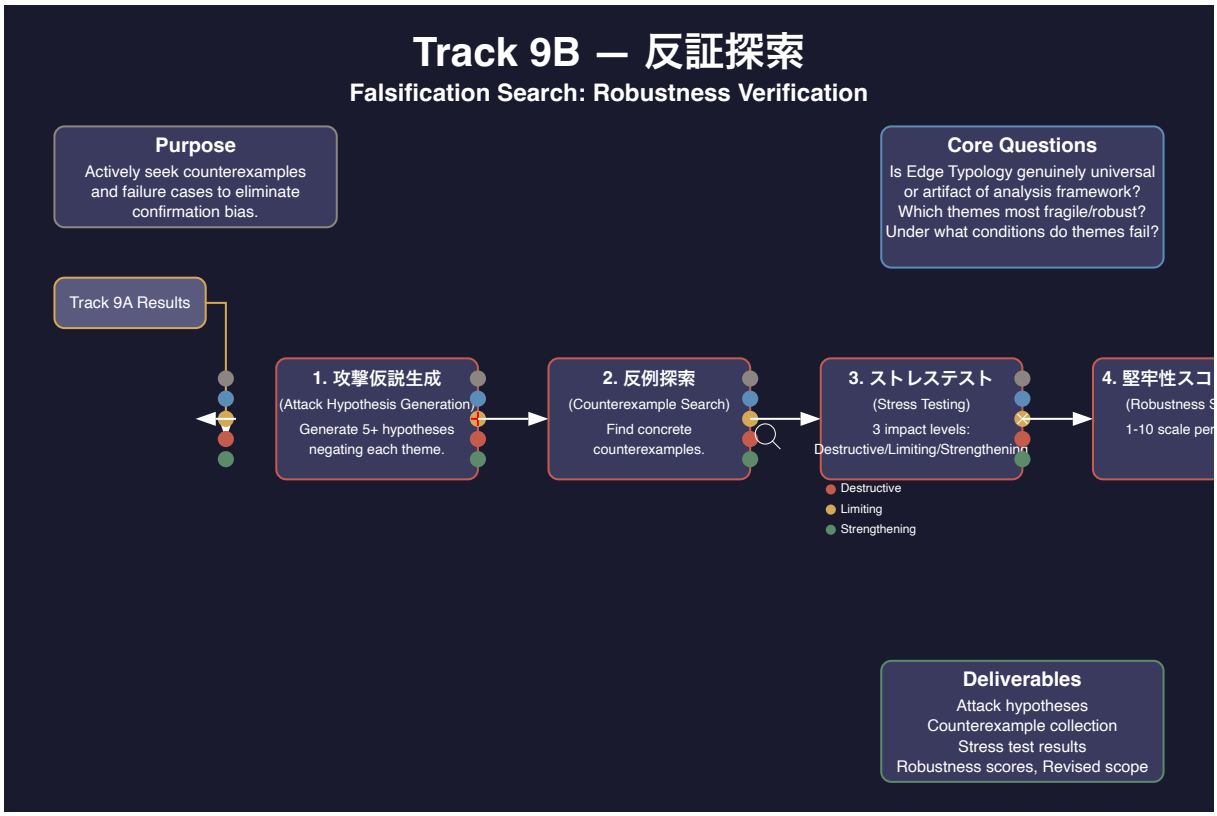


Figure 1: Track 9B Falsification Search — Plan Overview Infographic

Purpose

Actively seek counterexamples and failure cases for the Phase 8 structural themes. This track deliberately counters confirmation bias — the tendency to find the patterns we expect — by adopting an adversarial stance toward our own findings.

Core Questions

- Is the "Edge Typology observed across 28 domains" genuinely universal, or is the analysis framework itself generating the apparent similarity?
- Which of the five themes is most fragile? Which is most robust?
- Under what conditions does each theme fail to hold?

Methodology

Step 1: Attack Hypothesis Generation

Generate at least five hypotheses that negate each theme's claims.

Example: "Edge Typology reflects vocabulary similarity in the analyst's language, not substantive structural commonality."

Step 2: Counterexample Search

For each attack hypothesis, seek concrete counterexamples. Enumerate the theme's preconditions and identify cases where they do not hold.

Step 3: Stress Testing

Assess the impact of each counterexample on the theme.

Impact	Meaning
Destructive	Core claim collapses; fundamental restructuring required
Limiting	Scope narrows; claim becomes conditional
Strengthening	Counterexample can be explained; theme is reinforced

Step 4: Robustness Scoring

Assign each theme a robustness score from 1 to 10.

- **10**: All counterexamples explained; theme strengthened
- **5**: Some modifications needed; core intact
- **1**: Core claim collapsed; fundamental restructuring required

Dependencies

Most effective after Track 9A (Academic Grounding) produces results. Testing falsification against both supported and contested claims from 9A yields higher-precision verification.

Deliverables

- **Attack hypothesis list** — Hypotheses that negate theme claims
- **Counterexample collection** — Systematically recorded counterexamples
- **Stress test results** — Impact assessment for each counterexample
- **Robustness scores** — Per-theme scores with rationale
- **Revised scope** — Modified applicability boundaries where needed

Convergence Criteria

- 80% or more of major attack hypotheses have been tested
- Robustness scores are finalized
- Five or more loops completed with no new counterexamples